

Miner Hurlers Win Marathon

When Andy Cohen said he would use every pitcher on his University of Texas at El Paso staff to win a baseball game, he wasn't kidding.

Minutes before the clock struck midnight Friday at Dudley Field, Cohen saw Denver University patiently work over two of his best relievers for six runs in the top of the ninth and place runners on second and third with one out and the score tied 6-6.

Cohen sent Wes Zotz, into the lineup and the little southpaw responded with UTEP's 16th and 17th strikeouts of the game to stop Denver's comeback.

Designated hitter Rick Perez ended the three hour and 45 minute marathon in the bottom of the ninth with a run-scoring double high off the fence in right for a 7-6 UTEP victory.

Zotz won his second game in less than 24 hours Saturday night by striking out 11 Denver University batters, as the University of Texas at El Paso handed the Pioneers a 9-0 shellacking at Dudley Field.

Zotz was called to the mound late Friday night and stopped a Denver rally with two strikeouts and then came back Saturday and started where he left off, allowing Denver only five hits. Zotz is now 5-0 for the year and UTEP upped its record to 11-5 while Denver fell to 10-9. The two teams split their four-game series.

The Miners host Colorado State at 1 p.m. Monday at Dudley Field followed by a doubleheader Tuesday against the Rams before departing for Abilene where they will compete in the five-team Abilene Invitational.

"That lefty looked pretty good," said Cohen, not referring to Zotz but his starting pitcher Nick Fiorillo who was responsible for striking out 13

Pioneers before leaving the game after the seventh with UTEP ahead 6-0. "I don't know what happened to Jerry Walker. He couldn't get anybody out in the ninth."

Fiorillo tied the team strikeout record by fanning the last man he faced in the seventh and Walker broke the mark with a strikeout in the eighth.

The Miners tied another school record with four sacrifices in one game.

Dan Haygood accounted for UTEP's first two runs with a triple to right-center field after Bob Alsup and Dan Feagler slammed back-to-back singles in the fifth.

Two Denver errors in the seventh helped the Miners score four more runs before Fiorillo left the game in the seventh.

Suddenly, Walker lost control in the ninth, walking three straight batters. An error by shortstop Dan McMahon and a double with one out by Sam Taves cut UTEP's lead to one, sending Walker to the showers and Russ Bortell to the mound.

A walk and double sandwiched around another error by McMahon tied the score before Zotz was called to put out the fire.

Kirkley Picked For Team

PORTALES (AP) — Sharpshooter Bob Kirkley of Eastern New Mexico University was chosen to play in the seventh annual Pizza Hut Basketball Classic April 1 in Las Vegas, Nev.

The players are selected by fans who vote for the top eight college seniors from around the country. East and West squads are selected.